

MINISTRY OF STATISTICS AND PROGRAMME IMPLEMENTATION (MoSPI)

NATIONAL STATISTICAL SYSTEMS TRAINING ACADEMY (NSSTA) & CENTRAL STATISTICS OFFICE

STATUTORY TECHNICAL COMPENDIUM ON STATISTICAL METHODOLOGIES & FIDUCIARY NORMS

1. System of National Accounts (SNA 2008): GVA at Basic Prices vs. Factor Cost

Under the System of National Accounts (SNA 2008) harmonized by the National Accounts Division (NAD) of MoSPI, Gross Value Added (GVA) at basic prices is defined as the total value of gross output produced by resident establishment units minus the value of intermediate consumption utilized in production. Basic prices measure the amount receivable by the producer from the purchaser for a unit of a good or service produced as output, minus any tax payable (product tax), plus any subsidy receivable on that unit as a consequence of its production or sale. It explicitly excludes any transport charges invoiced separately by the producer. In contrast to the legacy metric of GVA at Factor Cost used prior to the 2011-12 base year revision, GVA at basic prices incorporates production taxes less production subsidies (such as land revenues, stamp duties, and municipal taxes that are independent of physical output volume). GDP at market prices is subsequently derived from GVA at basic prices by adding net product taxes (product taxes minus product subsidies).

2. Price Statistics Methodology: Producer Price Index (PPI) vs. Consumer Price Index (CPI)

The Price Statistics Division (PSD) compiles high-frequency price indices that serve distinct macroeconomic purposes. The Consumer Price Index (CPI) measures the average change over time in retail prices paid by final household consumers for a fixed basket of consumer goods and services (Base Year 2012 = 100), utilizing Laspeyres expenditure weights sourced from the Consumer Expenditure Survey (CES). Conversely, the Producer Price Index (PPI) evaluates price shifts from the perspective of the domestic seller/producer, measuring the average change in net selling prices received by producers for their output at the factory or farm gate, devoid of retail distribution markups, trade margins, and transport logistics. While CPI captures demand-side inflation and cost-of-living shocks, the PPI captures supply-side price pressures and cost-push inflation. In national accounts deflation, industry-specific PPI sub-indices serve as ideal output deflators to convert current price gross output into constant volume estimates.

3. Survey Sampling Methodology: FOD Multi-Stage Stratified Design & Hamlet Formation

The Field Operations Division (FOD) administers nationwide socio-economic household surveys (e.g., Periodic Labour Force Survey - PLFS). The sampling framework employs a two-stage stratified sampling design. First Stage Units (FSUs) comprise Census villages in rural sectors and Urban Frame Survey (UFS) blocks in urban sectors. Ultimate Stage Units (USUs) are resident households. To control field investigation workload and minimize clustering design effects in large FSUs, hamlet-group formation (rural) and sub-block formation (urban) is mandatory whenever the estimated population of an FSU reaches or exceeds 1,200 persons (approximately 300 households). The supervisor divides the entire FSU into mutually exclusive, geographically contiguous segments with identifiable natural boundaries of roughly equal population sizes. Two hamlet-groups/sub-blocks are then selected using Simple Random Sampling Without Replacement (SRSWOR), and sampling weights are calibrated to preserve unbiased Horvitz-Thompson Horvitz estimators.

4. Digital Governance: Statutory Obligations of Data Fiduciaries under Section 8 of DPDP Act 2023

Under the Digital Personal Data Protection (DPDP) Act 2023, government statistical directorates and field formations act as statutory Data Fiduciaries when collecting socio-economic and demographic microdata. Under Section 8 of the Act, a Data Fiduciary is legally obligated to ensure the accuracy, completeness, and consistency of personal data whenever such data is used to make a decision that affects the data principal or is disclosed to another Data Fiduciary. Furthermore, Section 8(5) mandates that Data Fiduciaries must implement appropriate technical and organizational measures (including end-to-end cryptographic encryption, access control logs, and role-based custody) to prevent personal data breaches.

Section 8(7) requires the mandatory erasure of personal data as soon as the specified purpose for which it was collected is no longer served, subject to statutory retention guidelines under the Collection of Statistics Act 2008.